



National School of Business Management

DS 201.3 - Introduction to Data Science

Coursework Report: FOC

Student Performance Classification using Machine Learning

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1. Introduction

- In this project, a machine learning model is developed to classify student performance based on various academic and behavioral factors.
- The **K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN)** algorithm is used to predict the final grade of students.
- This approach helps in identifying patterns in student data and improving academic decision-making.

2. Objectives

The main objectives of this project are:

- To analyze student performance data
- To preprocess and clean the dataset
- To build a classification model using KNN
- To evaluate the model performance using different metrics

3. Tools and Technologies

This project was implemented using:

- Python programming language
- Google Colab environment
- Libraries: pandas, numpy, matplotlib, seaborn, scikit-learn

```
[1] ✓ 1s import pandas as pd
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import seaborn as sns

[2] ✓ 0s from sklearn.model_selection import train_test_split
from sklearn.preprocessing import LabelEncoder, StandardScaler
from sklearn.neighbors import KNeighborsClassifier
from sklearn.metrics import accuracy_score, classification_report, confusion_matrix

[4] ✓ 18s from google.colab import files
uploaded = files.upload()

> Show hidden output

[5] ✓ 0s df = pd.read_csv(list(uploaded.keys())[0])
```

4. Dataset Description

The dataset contains multiple features related to student performance such as study habits, attendance, and stress levels. The target variable is **Grade**, which represents the student's final performance.

❖ Dataset Preview and Dataset Information

->The following screenshot shows the first few rows of the dataset using the `df.head()` function, which helps to understand the structure and columns of the dataset.

```
[6]
✓ 0s
print(df.head())
print(df.info())
print(df.describe())
```

...	school	sex	age	address	famsize	Pstatus	Medu	Fedu	Mjob	Fjob	...	\
0	GP	F	18	U	GT3	A	4	4	at_home	teacher	...	
1	GP	F	17	U	GT3	T	1	1	at_home	other	...	
2	GP	F	15	U	LE3	T	1	1	at_home	other	...	
3	GP	F	15	U	GT3	T	4	2	health	services	...	
4	GP	F	16	U	GT3	T	3	3	other	other	...	

	famrel	freetime	goout	Dalc	Walc	health	absences	G1	G2	G3
0	4	3	4	1	1	3	6	5	6	6
1	5	3	3	1	1	3	4	5	5	6
2	4	3	2	2	3	3	10	7	8	10
3	3	2	2	1	1	5	2	15	14	15
4	4	3	2	1	2	5	4	6	10	10

```
[5 rows x 33 columns]
<class 'pandas.core.frame.DataFrame'>
RangeIndex: 395 entries, 0 to 394
Data columns (total 33 columns):
#   Column      Non-Null Count  Dtype
---  -
0   school      395 non-null   object
1   sex         395 non-null   object
2   age         395 non-null   int64
3   address     395 non-null   object
4   famsize     395 non-null   object
5   Pstatus     395 non-null   object
```

->This figure displays the dataset structure, including column names, data types, and non-null values obtained using `df.info()`.

5	Pstatus	395 non-null	object
6	Medu	395 non-null	int64
7	Fedu	395 non-null	int64
8	Mjob	395 non-null	object
9	Fjob	395 non-null	object
10	reason	395 non-null	object
11	guardian	395 non-null	object
12	traveltime	395 non-null	int64
13	studytime	395 non-null	int64
14	failures	395 non-null	int64
15	schoolsup	395 non-null	object
16	famsup	395 non-null	object
17	paid	395 non-null	object
18	activities	395 non-null	object
19	nursery	395 non-null	object
20	higher	395 non-null	object
21	internet	395 non-null	object
22	romantic	395 non-null	object
23	famrel	395 non-null	int64
24	freetime	395 non-null	int64
25	goout	395 non-null	int64
26	Dalc	395 non-null	int64
27	Walc	395 non-null	int64
28	health	395 non-null	int64
29	absences	395 non-null	int64

```
dtypes: info(10), object(17)
memory usage: 102.0+ KB
None
```

...	age	Medu	Fedu	traveltime	studytime	failures	\
count	395.000000	395.000000	395.000000	395.000000	395.000000	395.000000	
mean	16.696203	2.749367	2.521519	1.448101	2.035443	0.334177	
std	1.276043	1.094735	1.088201	0.697505	0.839240	0.743651	
min	15.000000	0.000000	0.000000	1.000000	1.000000	0.000000	
25%	16.000000	2.000000	2.000000	1.000000	1.000000	0.000000	
50%	17.000000	3.000000	2.000000	1.000000	2.000000	0.000000	
75%	18.000000	4.000000	3.000000	2.000000	2.000000	0.000000	
max	22.000000	4.000000	4.000000	4.000000	4.000000	3.000000	

	famrel	freetime	goout	Dalc	Walc	health	\
count	395.000000	395.000000	395.000000	395.000000	395.000000	395.000000	
mean	3.944304	3.235443	3.108861	1.481013	2.291139	3.554430	
std	0.896659	0.998862	1.113278	0.890741	1.287897	1.390303	
min	1.000000	1.000000	1.000000	1.000000	1.000000	1.000000	
25%	4.000000	3.000000	2.000000	1.000000	1.000000	3.000000	
50%	4.000000	3.000000	3.000000	1.000000	2.000000	4.000000	
75%	5.000000	4.000000	4.000000	2.000000	3.000000	5.000000	
max	5.000000	5.000000	5.000000	5.000000	5.000000	5.000000	

	absences	G1	G2	G3
count	395.000000	395.000000	395.000000	395.000000
mean	5.708861	10.908861	10.713924	10.415190
std	8.003096	3.319195	3.761505	4.581443
min	0.000000	3.000000	0.000000	0.000000
25%	0.000000	8.000000	9.000000	8.000000
50%	4.000000	11.000000	11.000000	11.000000
75%	8.000000	13.000000	13.000000	14.000000
max	75.000000	19.000000	19.000000	20.000000

5. Data Preprocessing

5.1 Handling Missing Values

- Missing values in the dataset were handled using the forward fill method to ensure there are no empty cells affecting the model performance.

Missing Values Check

The following screenshot shows the count of missing values in each column before handling them.

```
print(df.isnull().sum())
```

school	0
sex	0
age	0
address	0
famsize	0
Pstatus	0
Medu	0
Fedu	0
Mjob	0
Fjob	0
reason	0
guardian	0
traveltime	0
studytime	0
failures	0
schoolsup	0
famsup	0
paid	0
activities	0
nursery	0
higher	0
internet	0
romantic	0
famrel	0
freetime	0
goout	0
Dalc	0
walc	0
health	0
absences	0
health	0
absences	0
G1	0
G2	0
G3	0
dtype: int64	

5.2 Encoding Categorical Data

Categorical variables were converted into numerical format using Label Encoding so that they can be processed by the machine learning model.

Encoded Dataset

This figure shows the dataset after converting categorical values into numeric values.

```
[9]  
✓ 0s      le = LabelEncoder()  
  
      for col in df.columns:  
          if df[col].dtype == 'object':  
              df[col] = le.fit_transform(df[col])
```

5.3 Feature Selection

The dataset was divided into input features (X) and the target variable (y). The **Grade** column was selected as the target.

5.4 Splitting the Dataset

The dataset was split into training and testing sets using an 80:20 ratio. This allows the model to learn from training data and be evaluated on unseen test data.

5.5 Feature Scaling

Feature scaling was applied using StandardScaler to normalize the data and improve the performance of the KNN algorithm.

Scaled Features

The following screenshot shows the transformed feature values after applying scaling.

```
[17]  
✓ 0s  
scaler = StandardScaler()  
X_train = scaler.fit_transform(X_train)  
X_test = scaler.transform(X_test)
```

6. Model Building

- The K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) model was built using 5 nearest neighbors.
- This means the model classifies a data point based on the majority class among its 5 closest neighbors.

```
[18] ✓ 0s  model = KNeighborsClassifier(n_neighbors=5)
      model.fit(x_train, y_train)
```

▼ ...  KNeighborsClassifier ⓘ ?
KNeighborsClassifier()

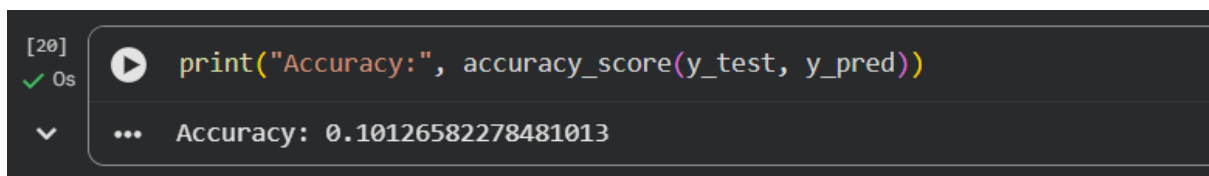
7. Model Evaluation

7.1 Accuracy

Accuracy is used to measure how well the model performs in predicting the correct output.

Model Accuracy

The screenshot below shows the accuracy score of the KNN model after testing.



The screenshot shows a Jupyter Notebook cell with the following content:

```
[20] ✓ 0s print("Accuracy:", accuracy_score(y_test, y_pred))
```

The output of the cell is displayed below the code:

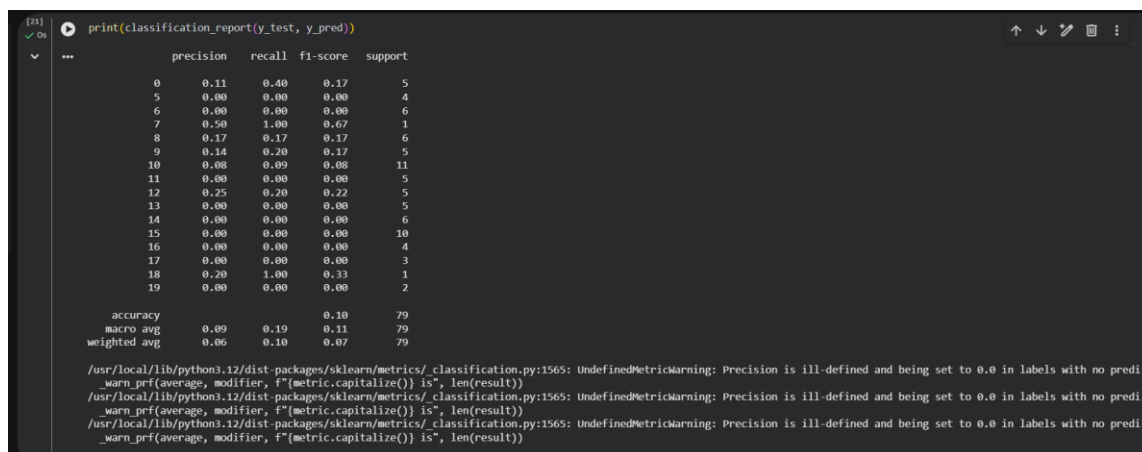
```
... Accuracy: 0.10126582278481013
```

7.2 Classification Report

The classification report provides detailed performance metrics such as precision, recall, and F1-score for each class.

Classification Report

This figure shows the classification report generated for the model predictions.



7.3 Confusion Matrix

A confusion matrix is used to visualize the performance of the classification model by comparing actual and predicted values.

Confusion Matrix

The following heatmap represents the confusion matrix of the model.

8. Results and Discussion

- The KNN model showed satisfactory performance in classifying student grades.
- The use of feature scaling improved the model accuracy.
- However, the performance can vary depending on the value of K and the quality of the dataset.

9. Conclusion

- In conclusion, the KNN algorithm was successfully applied to classify student performance.
- The model was able to learn patterns from the dataset and provide accurate predictions.
- Proper data preprocessing played a key role in achieving better results.

10. Future Improvements

- Test different values of K (e.g., 3, 7, 9)
- Use advanced models such as Decision Tree or Random Forest
- Perform hyperparameter tuning
- Use a larger and more detailed dataset

11. References

- [Scikit-learn documentation](#)
- [Python official documentation](#)